

Winning attention, losing players.

An independent product marketing strategy for Battlegrounds Mobile India: how the country's most-country's most-watched battle royale turns record esports viewership back into active, paying players.

Market & competitive analysis · Primary research · Segmentation · Positioning · GTM · Metrics

The category leader by **attention** is losing losing **players**, not payers.

BGMI leads on esports reach, and Krafton reports paying users grew 27% in 2025. Yet monthly actives are falling and its player funnel is far smaller than Free Fire Max's. This is a scale and retention problem, not a demand or willingness-to-pay problem, and it is addressable.

Demand is not the problem. The audience is already here.

Reach, viewership and brand strength are all working.

260M+

CUMULATIVE DOWNLOADS

Reported by Krafton, Q1 2026.

930M+

ESPORTS VIEWS 2025

Up from 308.6M in 2024, per Krafton.

86.8M

UNIQUE ESPORTS VIEWERS

984M YouTube impressions across BGMI IPs.

~730K

PEAK VIEWERS, BMPS 2026

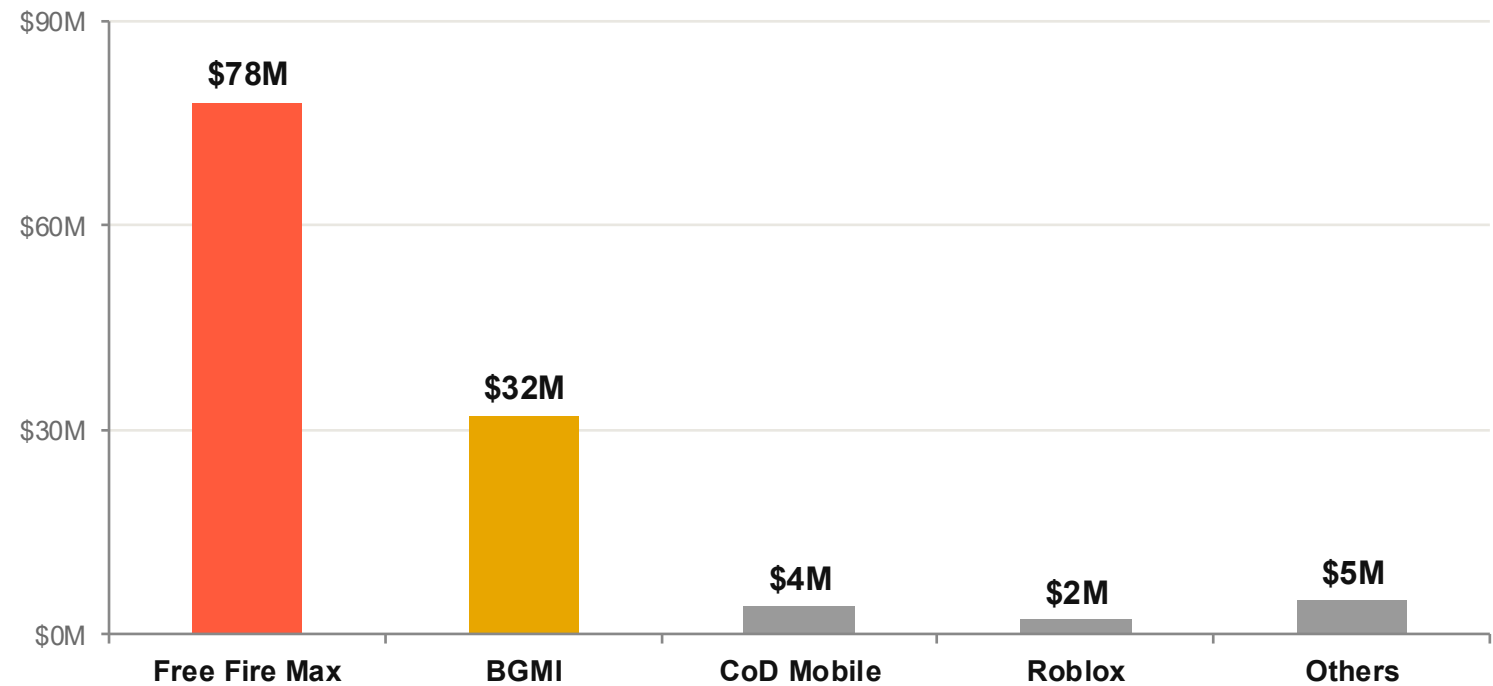
BGMI record; BGIS 2026 peaked at 600K+.

The insight to carry: viewership is an owned, warm audience. Hypothesis to validate: part of those 86.8M viewers are lapsed players who still follow the game, a reactivation channel not yet converted.

Free Fire Max out-earns BGMI through reach, not revenue per player.

Estimated annual India revenue, Mar 2025 to Mar 2026 (US \$M). Third-party estimates; figures vary by source.

Free Fire Max is published by Garena; BGMI by Krafton. Valorant Mobile is China-only and is excluded; its former bar is folded into Others.



2.4x

Free Fire Max's estimated revenue lead over BGMI in India.

1.45x

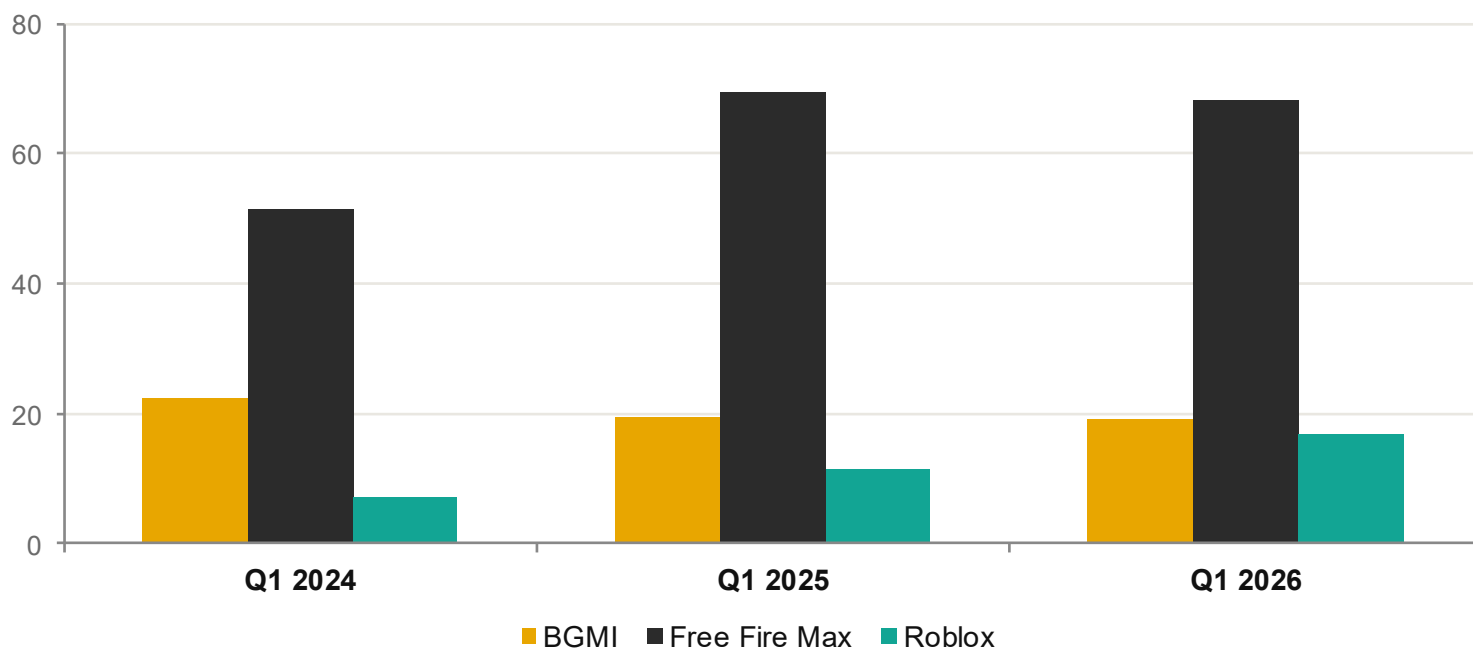
BGMI's estimated revenue per MAU vs Free Fire Max (~\$1.66 vs ~\$1.14), from this deck's estimates.

BGMI earns more per player. The gap is the size of the player base.

BGMI's active base is contracting while Roblox grows.

Estimated monthly active users, India, Q1 2024 to Q1 2026 (millions). Directional only; trackers differ.

Publishers: BGMI (Krafton), Free Fire Max (Garena), Roblox (Roblox Corp.).



-14%

BGMI's estimated MAU change, Q1 2024 to Q1 2026.

19.3M

BGMI's estimated MAU, down from 22.4M.

Roblox: 7.1M to 16.8M (estimated), the fastest-growing substitute.

BGMI earns more per player. Its player funnel is smaller.

The gap is reach and offer design, not willingness to pay: Krafton reports paying users up 27% in 2025.

Why the paying funnel is smaller

Accessibility. Free Fire Max runs on entry-level phones, widening its funnel; Krafton plans BGMI Lite for late 2026.

Spend design. Free Fire Max leans on frequent, low-ticket buys; BGMI spans Royal Pass and premium XSuit drops.

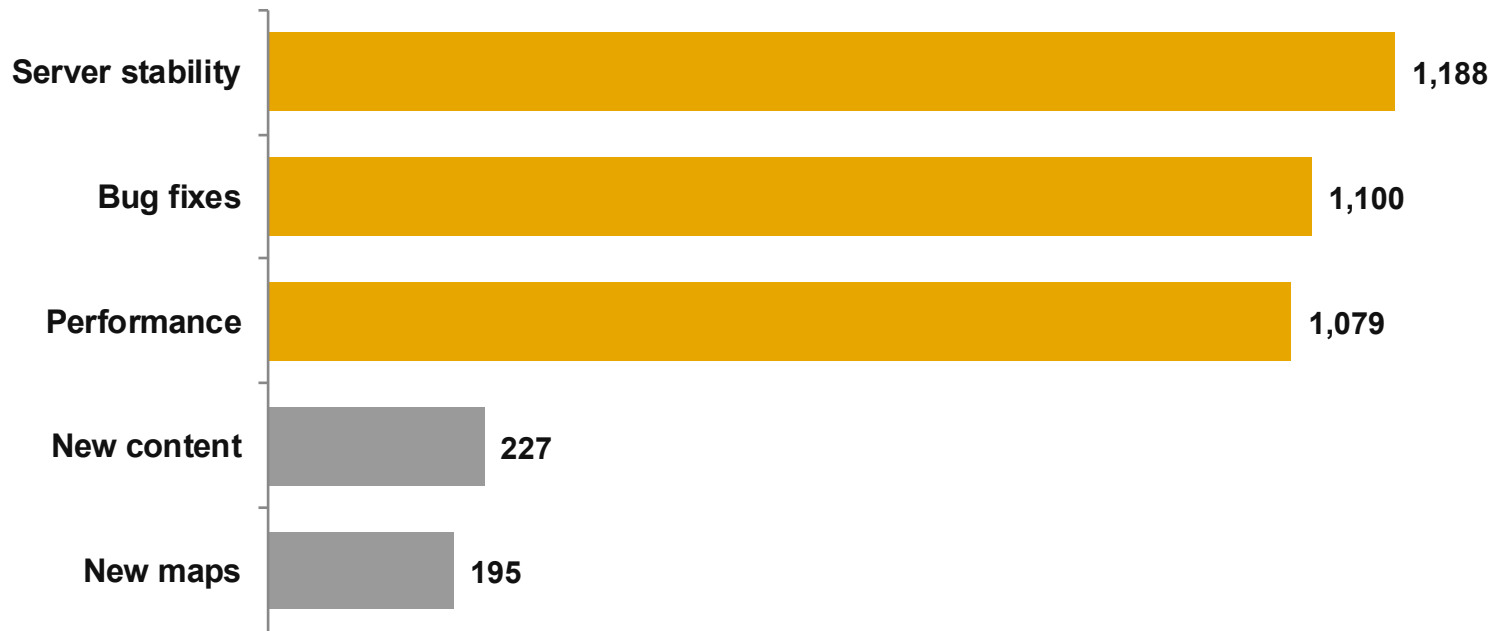
Offer cadence. More frequent, low-priced offers would widen BGMI's funnel without discounting premium drops.

	Archetype A	Archetype B
Phone	\$150 Android	\$700 Phone
Plays	Free Fire Max	BGMI
Access	Easy	Easy
Capacity to pay	Lower	Higher
Purchase pattern	Frequent	Occasional

The play: Convert brand collaborations into frequent, low-ticket, UPI-native purchase moments rather than one-off drops. Grow paying players through frequency and desirability, not price or advantage.

Users prioritize reliability over new content.

Primary research: 1,257-response survey plus 50 in-depth interviews. Priorities selected (multi-select).



65%

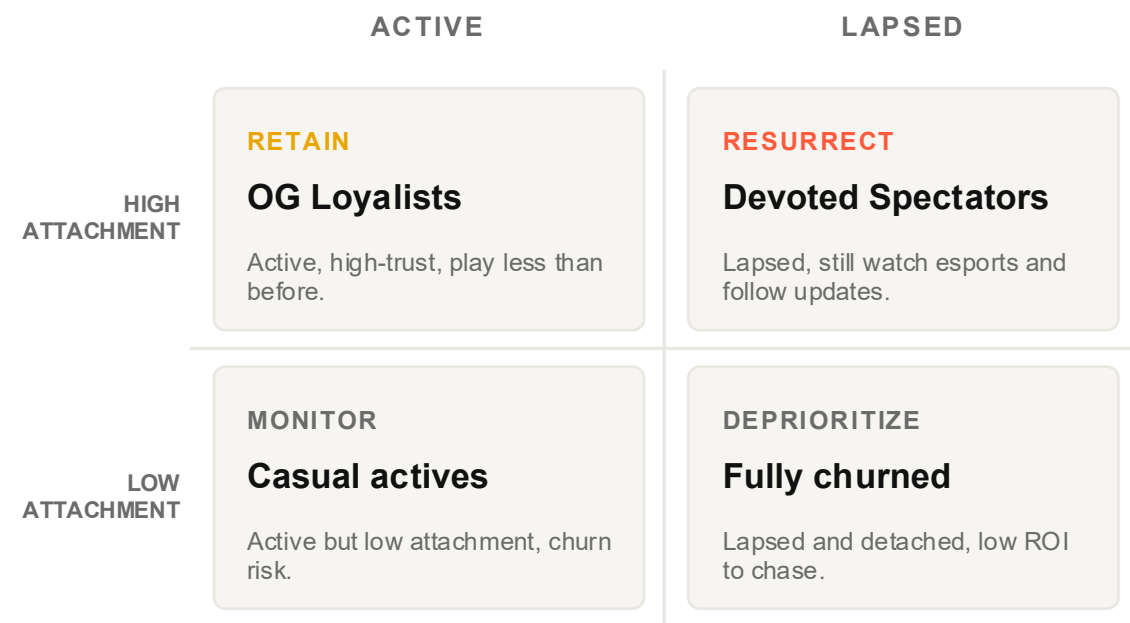
say their experience worsened over six months, 45% called it significant.

6.8 vs 3.7

Average experience score: players with no server errors vs near-daily errors (10-point scale).

Keep one, win back one, watch one, recruit one.

Activity from the survey and interviews; attachment proxied by developer trust. Treat boundaries as hypotheses.



Provenance and evidence

- 73% of the 1,257 survey respondents are daily users (the active base).
- About half of the 50 interviewees had reduced or stopped playing (the lapsed base).
- Retain and Resurrect cohorts are drawn from primary research.
- The Recruit target below is market analysis, not a survey finding.

RECRUIT Next-cohort teens (13 to 18)

Not in the survey. A prospective segment from market analysis, not sized here: mobile-native, drifting to Roblox and short-form.

Three decision profiles, one per go-to-market motion.

Behavioural profiles, not demographics. Each maps to a single motion.

RETAIN

The OG Loyalist

WHO

Since the PUBG era, ranked-focused, plays less than before.

WANTS / PAIN

Competitive integrity and status; alienated by reliability decline.

MOVED BY

Visible server and anti-cheat fixes; a vintage, classic-era campaign.

THE PLAY

We fixed what you flagged.

RESURRECT

The Devoted Spectator

WHO

Stopped playing, still watches BGIS and BMPS, follows every update.

WANTS / PAIN

Left over bugs and deprioritization (interviews), not boredom. Trust lapsed.

MOVED BY

Credible proof it is fixed, met inside the esports they already watch.

THE PLAY

Highest-value win-back, if lapsed players are in the 930M-view audience.

RECRUIT

The Next-Cohort Teen

WHO

13 to 18, mobile-native, splitting time with Roblox and short-form.

WANTS / PAIN

Play with friends, create, belong; BGMI feels like an older game.

MOVED BY

Creators they follow; UGC that lets them build; low-friction entry.

THE PLAY

Recruit before Free Fire Max and Roblox lock them in.

BGMI is contested on two maps, not one list.

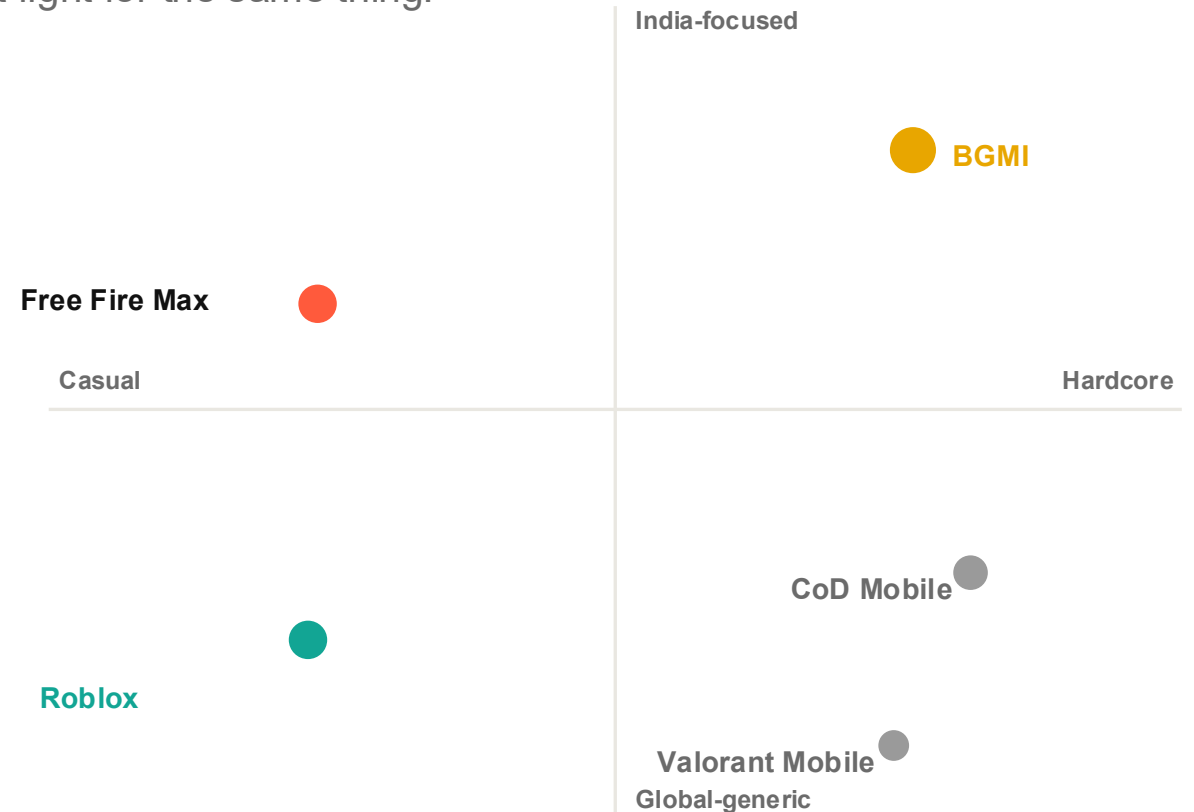
Free Fire Max, CoD Mobile, Valorant Mobile and Roblox do not fight for the same thing.

Arena 1, battle royale

Free Fire Max (mass-casual, the revenue rival), CoD Mobile, and Valorant Mobile (a potential entrant, still China-only). Contest: the BR player and the ranked grind.

Arena 2, attention and platform

Roblox and short-form video. Contest: the next cohort's time, and the creation-platform future Krafton is already building toward.



Where each rival wins, and BGMI's counter.

	BGMI Krafton	Free Fire Max Garena	Roblox Roblox Corp.
<i>Fights for</i>	The hardcore BR player	Mass-casual BR, tier 2 and 3	The next cohort's time
<i>Core strength</i>	Esports, culture, mindshare	Monetization depth, low-end reach	UGC network, creation loop
<i>Monetization</i>	Cosmetic-led: Royal Pass to premium drops	Gacha and progression, deep	UGC economy (Robux)
<i>Where it wins</i>	Attention and prestige	Reach and paying-funnel size	Younger-audience engagement
<i>BGMI's counter</i>	reference point	UGC cosmetics economy, no P2W	Player-created content platform

Both counters converge on one move: an owned creator-led content economy that addresses the reach gap and the retention leak together.

■ POSITIONING

For competitive Indian players who want a battle royale they can **trust, BGMI is the India-exclusive battle royale built on competitive **integrity** and player-created **content**.**

The axis shift: stop competing on most content and biggest collabs, a race Free Fire Max wins and anyone can enter. Move the fight to reliability, integrity and a creation platform, where switching costs are highest and the survey says the pain actually is.

The narrative, and the evidence beneath each claim.

Three pillars, each anchored to a data point rather than a slogan.

Built to be trusted

Server stability and anti-cheat as headline commitments, not patch notes.

OG Loyalists, push: "We fixed the servers. The rank grind is back."

Proof: reliability was the most-selected priority (survey).

India's own battleground

Local identity, local servers, local competitive scene.

Devoted Spectators, pre-roll: "The game you still watch. Now worth playing again."

Proof: 930M+ esports views in 2025; BMPS 2026 set BGMI's peak-viewer record.

A game India builds

Player-created cosmetics; creators earn; the catalogue is yours to shape.

Next cohort, Reels: "Build the skin. Wear the skin. Get paid."

Proof: Krafton is investing in World of Wonder, BGMI's creation mode.

Sequence the plan: stabilize, reactivate, then grow.

A staged plan gated on reliability. Demand generation waits until the product experience is fixed.

PHASE 1

Stabilize and communicate

- Reallocate update spend toward servers, bugs, anti-cheat.
- Make the fix visible; trust is a comms job, not just an eng one.

Reliability gate before any spend

PHASE 2

Reactivate the base

- Vintage, classic-era campaign for OG loyalists and spectators.
- Creators and streamers turn it into clips, PR and social reach.

Targets Retain + Resurrect

PHASE 3

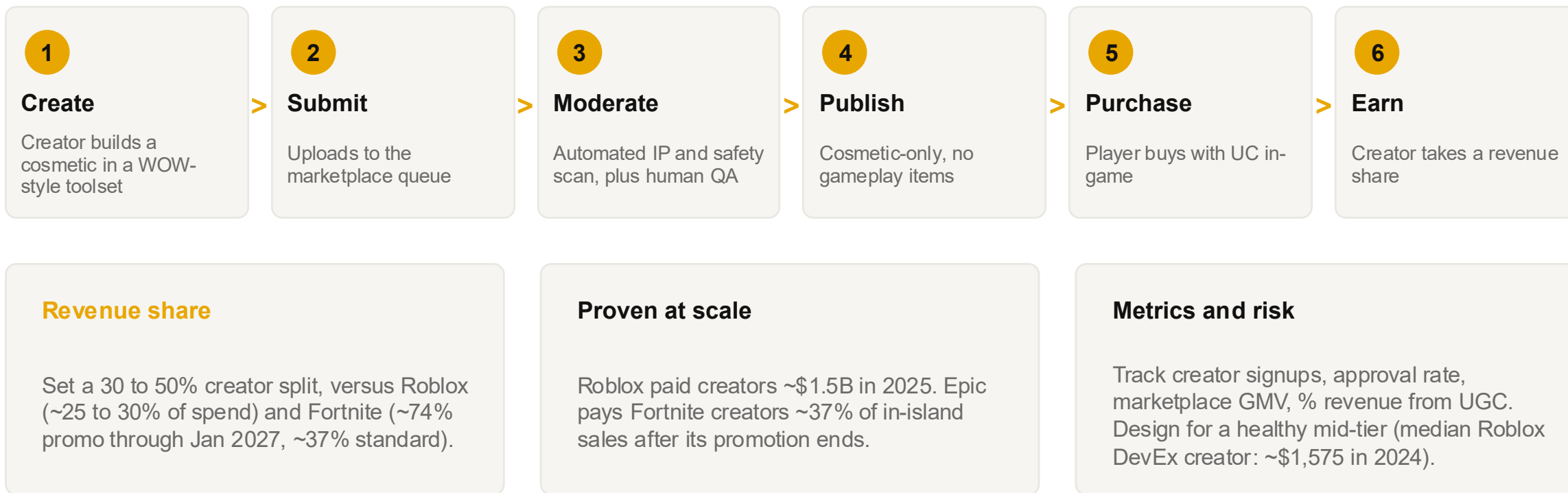
Recruit and monetize

- Recruit the next cohort (13+) via creator partnerships and Shorts challenges, DPDP-compliant.
- Convert brand collaborations into recurring, low-ticket cosmetics revenue.

Targets Recruit; widens the paying funnel

A creator-led content economy, specified for Product and Growth.

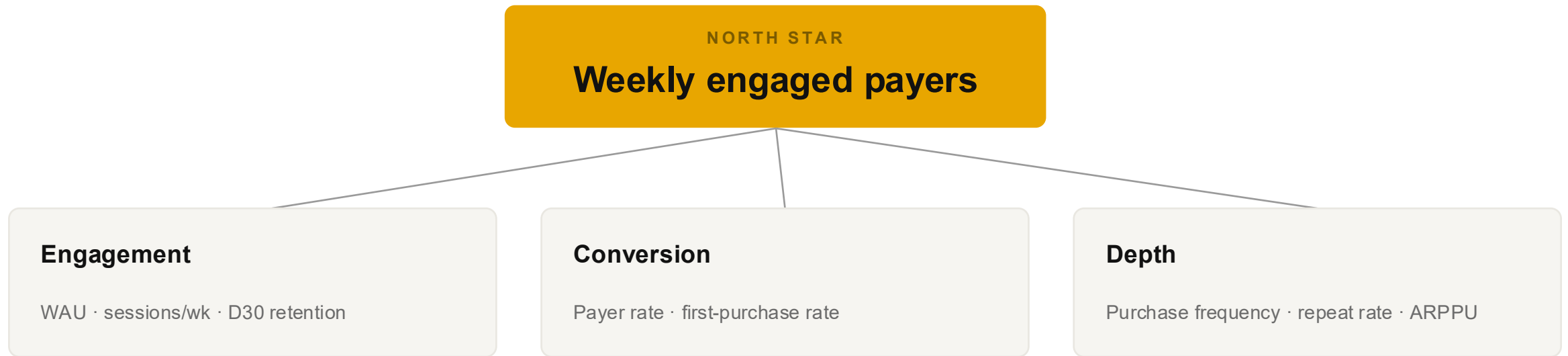
Extend the existing creation platform from levels to cosmetics. A concrete, shippable pipeline.



One North Star metric, with its inputs, not competing metrics.

Weekly engaged payers couples engagement and monetization, so neither can be gamed alone.

Definition: unique players with a session and a purchase in a rolling 7-day window. Driven by $WAU \times \text{payer rate}$.



Why weekly, and why coupled: BGMI's gap versus Free Fire Max is reach and purchase habit, and engagement that never converts. Retained payers, conversion and ARPPU are inputs to this number, not alternative North Stars.

What BGMI should not do: chase installs, ship pay-to-win, or optimize ARPPU alone by squeezing whales.

■ RISKS AND VALIDATION

Where this fails, and how we'd know.

HONEST RISKS

- Reliability positioning is a promise the product must keep. Messaging cannot outrun the servers.
- The aging-cohort read is a hypothesis (acquisition data was unavailable). Validate before over-investing.
- Free Fire Max's reach could keep widening the funnel gap faster than the UGC economy matures.

WHAT'S NEXT

- A/B test reliability-led versus content-led messaging on win-back.
- Churn-intent model on the survey base to size the lapsed opportunity.
- Longitudinal satisfaction tracking tied to the North Star metric.
- Instrument UGC revenue per payer from day one.

> Win attention today. Convert it into active, paying players before the window closes.

The end-to-end product marketing remit, demonstrated.

The domain is consumer software; the same research, segmentation and GTM methods apply across products.

Market & competitive analysis

Revenue and MAU benchmarks, two competitive arenas, and a rival-by-rival battlecard.

Primary & secondary research

A 1,257-response survey, 50 interviews, and third-party market and investor data triangulated.

Segmentation, targeting & personas

Behavioural segments and three decision-profile personas.

Positioning & messaging

A positioning statement and an evidence-backed messaging framework.

Go-to-market & lifecycle

A sequenced, reliability-gated retain, resurrect and recruit plan.

Monetization & business modeling

A funnel-size diagnosis and a shippable UGC creation economy.

Metrics & experimentation

A North Star metric, an input tree, and an A/B validation roadmap.

Executive storytelling

A data-to-recommendation narrative built for cross-functional decisions.

Every figure in this deck, sourced.

My role: I designed and led the n=1,257 survey and the 50 interviews. External figures are attributed below.

PRIMARY RESEARCH

Self-designed survey (n=1,257) and 50 interviews. Repo: github.com/naveen-raj-kanagaraj/product-analytics-user-experience

REVENUE & MARKET

Sensor Tower-based estimates, India (Mar 2025 to Mar 2026), compiled; figures vary by source.

ENGAGEMENT (MAU)

Third-party, Sensor Tower-based estimates, India; trackers differ, so treat as directional.

REGULATORY

Promotion and Regulation of Online Gaming Act, 2025; Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023.

ESPORTS

Krafton (2025 esports views, 86.78M viewers); Esports Charts (BMPS 2026, ~729K peak); BGIS 2026 600K+ peak (Krafton channel).

COMPANY STRATEGY

Krafton FY2025 and Q1 2026: paying users +27% (2025) and +17% (Q1 2026), 260M+ downloads, BGMI Lite plans.

UGC PRECEDENTS

Roblox Economic Impact Report and 2025 DevEx payouts; Epic in-island transaction terms.

METHODOLOGY NOTE

Revenue and MAU are third-party estimates. Archetypes A and B are illustrative, not survey respondents.